UNIT 6: CONJUNCTIONS & PREPOSITIONS

Coordinating conjunctions			and, or, so, but, for, nor
Subordinating conjunctions	Conjunctions in noun clauses		that, if, whether
	Conjunctions in adverb clauses	Time	when, while, before, after, as soon as, until, since
		Reason	because, since, as, now that
		Condition and concession	if, unless, as long as, once, in case, although, though, while, even though, even if
		Purpose and result	so that, so/such ~ that, in order that

1 Coordinating Conjunctions

Coordinating conjunctions are words that link words, phrases, or clauses of equal importance. Typical coordinating conjunctions are *and* and *or*.

1) Joining words

- Employees are asked to be efficient **and** creative.

adjective + *and* + adjective

2) Joining phrases

- People usually commute by bus **or** on foot.

phrase + *or* + phrase

3) Joining clauses

- Mr. Sierto began a new study **and** I started sorting documents.

independent clause + *and* + independent clause

2 Correlative Conjunctions

Correlative conjunctions come in pair, thanks to which one can be inferred from the other. TOEIC test questions often ask to identify the other conjunction of a correlative pair.

1) both A and B = A and B alike

- The instructional video was enjoyed by **both** adults **and** children.

2) not only A but (also) B

- **Not only** management **but also** employees are aware of the importance.

3) either A or B

- The last shipment will arrive **either** today **or** tomorrow.

4) neither A nor B

- **Neither** my supervisor **nor** her assistants are responsible for the faults.

3 Prepositions vs. Conjunctions of Cause/Reason

1) Conjunctions of cause/reason

because/as/since/[now that] + Subject + Verb

- **Because** everyone was available on Sunday, he held a housewarming party.

2) Prepositions of cause/reason

[because of]/[owing to]/[thanks to]/[due to] + Noun/Gerund

- **Because of** noise from the construction site, I can't focus on my study.

3) Conjunctive adverbs of result

Conjunctive adverbs of result such as *hence*, *therefore*, *consequently*, and *thus* introduce the result of an action or event expressed earlier. These adverbs are often used in the following pattern:

Sentence/Clause + Conjunctive Adverb/Coordinating Conjunction + Sentence/Clause

- I have checked the list carefully and **thus** there should be no mistakes.
- Ms. Peterson was fired last week; **therefore**, she is looking for a job.

4 Prepositions vs. Conjunctions of Contrast and Concession

1) Conjunctions of concession

Although/[Even though]/Though + Subject + Verb
While + Subject + Verb

- **Although** he is right, I don't still trust him.

2) Prepositions of concession

[In spite of]/Despite + Noun Phrase

- **In spite of** the heavy rain, this fund-raising concert took place outdoors.

3) Conjunctive adverbs of contrast

Conjunctive adverbs of contrast such as *however*, *nevertheless*, and *nonetheless* are used to show contrast. These adverbs should only be used in the following pattern:

Sentence/Clause + Conjunctive Adverb/Coordinating Conjunction + Sentence/Clause

- Sales representatives explained the function of the machine; **however**, customers didn't listen carefully.
- He heard the bad news; **nonetheless**, he decided to invest in the project.

- Liên từ + Mệnh đề
because, although, since, if, ...

- Giới từ + Danh từ / Cụm danh từ /V-ing
because of, despite , inspite of, due to

- Từ nối: Nối 2 câu độc lập, đứng sau ; hoặc .
however, therefore, nevertheless, thus, ...

- Tương quan
both .... and ....
Either ... or ....
Neithor .... nor ....
Not only .... but also....

Practice 1:

công nhân thời vụ

1 _____ the division hired temporary workers to complete the project, the company saved more money.

(A) Even Even if / even though

(B) However từ nối

(C) Nevertheless

(D) Since

một cách kỹ lưỡng số liệu

2 We thoroughly checked all the figures; _____, our supervisor found a number of mistakes.

(A) while

(B) however

(C) although

(D) as

3 _____ a downturn in the market, considerable downsizing is still needed to ensure our company's competitiveness.

(A) Because

(B) Nevertheless

(C) Due to + N

(D) Thus

4 _____ the tourists did not arrive in the designated area on schedule, they missed their flight.

(A) Because

(B) Therefore có ,

(C) Owing to giới từ + danh từ

(D) Yet

5 _____ concerns over weak sales, the company cannot come up with effective solutions.

(A) Thanks to

(B) Despite

(C) Because

(D) Even though

6 Ms. Arden thoroughly prepared for the interview _____ she did not know what would happen during her job interview.

(A) although

(B) while

(C) between

(D) since

7 _____ several flaws, their proposal for the shopping complex was adopted.

(A) In spite of

(B) Unless + mệnh đề

(C) Even though

(D) Because of

8 Meetings were postponed _____ unexpected power failures.

(A) despite of sai

(B) as a result of + N phase

(C) while + mệnh đề

(D) nonetheless trạng từ nối, k đi với danh từ

9 The company provides not only reliable information _____ also valuable skills.

(A) and

(B) but

(C) or

(D) so

10 Please make sure that newspapers should be placed _____ in the black bins or next to the copy machine.

(A) not only

(B) neither

(C) for

(D) either

Prepositional phrases [Preposition + Noun] are used to express various notions such as time, place, reason, or method.

1 Common Prepositions

1) at: time, place, rate, price, speed

❶ Time: before a specific point of time

- at 3 o'clock
- at night
- at the end of this month
- at noon
- at midnight
- at all times

❷ Place: before a specific place

- at the desk
- at the computer

❸ Rate, price, speed

- at a rate of 10 miles an hour = at a speed of 10 miles an hour
- at a competitive price
- at a rate of 10 dollars per month

2) in: place, subject, topic, time

❶ Place: before a place/location

- in the city
- in New York

❷ Subject, topic

- advances in medical technology
- decline in its population
- experience in the same field

❸ Time

- in the morning
- in the winter
- in the 21st century
- in 10 minutes
- in April
- in 2020
- in the last[past] 3 years

※ Common expressions

in detail	in writing	in place
in conclusion	in advance	

3) **on:** place, time

❶ Place

- **on** my desk
- **on** the waiting list
- **on** the fourth floor
- **on** the last page

❷ Time: day of the week, date, a particular day

- **on** Monday
- **on** May 10

※ Common expressions

every hour on the hour	on one's way to
on business	on the rise

4) **over:** place, time, range, means, topic

❶ Place

- **over** a low flame

❷ Time

- **over** the past few years

❸ Range

- **over** 100 competitors

❹ Means

- **over** the phone
- **over** the Internet

❺ Topic

- a dispute **over** the proposal

5) **for:** price, purpose, duration, reason

❶ Price

- **for** free = free of charge
- have a good lunch **for** 9 dollars

❷ Purpose

- stabilize prices of commodities **for** people
- **for** commercial purposes

❸ Duration

- **for** a year

2 Commonly Confused Prepositions

Below are some pairs of prepositions which often cause confusion.

1) *for* vs. *during*

❶ *for* + a number, period of time

- **for** 10 years
- **for** the last 5 years

❷ *during* + *the* + specific event, period of time

- **during** the summer vacation
- **during** the training session

※ **Reference** Other prepositions that also express "duration"

❶ **over**

over the last several years

❷ **through**

We'll prepare for the international food exhibition **through** the rest of the period.

2) *from* vs. *since*

❶ *from* + a definite time in the past: used to express the time in the past when something started. It often goes with the Past Simple tense.

- I started to work here **from** last month.

❷ *since* + a definite time in the past: used to talk about an event which has continued from that definite time up to the present time. It often goes with the Present Perfect tense.

- I have been attending this university **since** 3 years ago.

3) *by* vs. *until*

❶ *by*: used to refer to an action or event completed at or before a particular time. Verbs often go with *by* include:

finish complete return submit

❷ *until*: If something happens *until* a particular time, it happens during the period before that time and stops at that time. Verbs often go with *until* include:

stay open last wait

Practice 2:

1. Evan's Restaurant will close _____ 9 o'clock starting next week.
   (A) at
   (B) in
   (C) on
   (D) to

2. Employees who would like to take their summer vacations must inform Mr. Wilson in the HR Department _____ October 21.
   (A) by
   (B) until
   (C) for
   (D) as

3. The CEO will not be coming to the office _____ next week.
   (A) with
   (B) at
   (C) until
   (D) on

4. The packages were shipped from the warehouse _____ Thursday.
   (A) in
   (B) into
   (C) at
   (D) on

5. Toby's Surfing is located _____ Great Beach Road next to the police station.
   (A) in
   (B) on
   (C) at
   (D) by

6. The UNESE is a large organization with a lot of offices _____ the world.
   (A) on
   (B) at
   (C) along
   (D) throughout

7. _____ construction delays on Lake Street, it takes 15 more minutes to get to work.
   (A) Because of
   (B) Since
   (C) As
   (D) In spite of

8. Walk _____ the street to Apple Street and turn left.
   (A) along
   (B) by
   (C) as
   (D) about

Practice 3:

Questions 131-134 refer to the following article.

DODOMA (21 May)—Dodoma Gas and Electric (DGE) and Arusha Power (Arupo) have announced today that they ------- **131.** into one company. The effective date of the merger is 1 July. The soon-to-be ------- **132.** company will operate under the new name Tanzania Energy Solutions. DGE serves about 250,000 households and businesses, while Arupo serves about 90,000. ------- **133.** . In a joint statement, CEOs Johnathan Gashaza of DGE and Coretha Komba of Arupo assured customers they will not see any service changes. ------- **134.** also said there will be no employee layoffs.

131. (A) have been merging
(B) will be merging
(C) have merged
(D) are merged

132. (A) renovated
(B) informed
(C) created
(D) acquired

133. (A) The financial terms of the agreement have yet to be disclosed.
(B) The energy sector is vital to Tanzania's development.
(C) Both companies have an exceptional grasp of the international financial market.
(D) Both companies have an excellent reputation in their respective industries.

134. (A) We
(B) It
(C) They
(D) She

Questions 135-138 refer to the following letter.

29 August

Alvin Mangubat
Director of Human Resources
Farsten Products, Ltd.
549 Castor Boulevard
Winnipeg MB R3E 2S2

Dear Mr. Mangubat,

I am writing to apply for the mechanical engineer position advertised on your Web site. I think I have much to offer Farsten Products' design ------- **135.** as an employee.

------- **136.** . I am currently an engineer at Yount Systems, where I have worked on machine and engine designs for the last six years. ------- **137.** that, I was employed by Zelenka Industries, where I helped develop efficient methods for recycling scrap steel.

I have enclosed my résumé, which ------- **138.** more details about my work history and my educational background. I look forward to meeting with you to discuss how my skills and experience can benefit Farsten Products.

Sincerely,

Gail Paek
Encl.

135. (A) phase
(B) department
(C) consultant
(D) expertise

136. (A) Your Web site also listed an internship that would be a great opportunity.
(B) The job description said that applicants should have an advanced degree.
(C) My manager replied to your request last week.
(D) My extensive experience makes me an ideal fit for your company.

137. (A) Regarding
(B) Following
(C) Contrary to
(D) Prior to

138. (A) give
(B) gave
(C) gives
(D) is giving

Questions 139-142 refer to the following e-mail.

To: Lathifah Suryani <lsuryani@cmail.com>
From: Jabari Evers <eversj@pems.com>
Date: May 18
Subject: Text Messages

Dear Ms. Suryani,

In order to ------- **139.** our patients as effectively and reliably as possible, we are now offering them the option of receiving appointment reminders and other relevant information via our text-messaging system. You are currently registered to receive our materials via e-mail. ------- **140**. If you would like to add text messaging to your mode of communication with us or would like to change your ------- **141.** from e-mail to text messaging, please let us know at your earliest convenience. ------- **142.** goal is to give you relevant and useful information about your health and about the products and services we offer in a timely fashion.

Jabari Evers
Customer Care Representative
Professional Eye Care Management Services

139. (A) serve
(B) care
(C) work
(D) provide

140. (A) You have not been in our office recently.
(B) No action is required if you like your current service.
(C) We have great products you can buy.
(D) E-mail messages are not available to all patients.

141. (A) prefer
(B) preferential
(C) preferred
(D) preference

142. (A) Their
(B) My
(C) Your
(D) Our

Questions 143-146 refer to the following article.

TOFTLUND (10 June)—Row after row of electric cars in local parking areas seem to indicate that the city of Toftlund has begun to give up on gasoline-fueled cars. In fact, 20 percent of the cars on Toftlund city streets are electric, but this number is changing at a ------- pace. **143.**

To some extent, this is due to the city's generous tax ------- offered to electric car drivers. **144.** According to Anne Rasmussen, president of Toftlund Green Business, more attractive designs and longer-lasting batteries have ------- made a difference. Ms. Rasmussen predicts the number **145.** of electric cars in Toftlund will more than double in the coming years. ------- . **146.**

143. (A) rapid
(B) brief
(C) narrow
(D) valuable

144. (A) beneficial
(B) benefitting
(C) benefits
(D) to benefit

145. (A) just
(B) over
(C) very
(D) also

146. (A) Moreover, she likes the convenience of having recharging stations on highways.
(B) In fact, she believes that in twenty years only electric cars will be sold here.
(C) Therefore, she feels that the price of electric cars is too high.
(D) She notes that the population of Toftlund has been decreasing steadily.